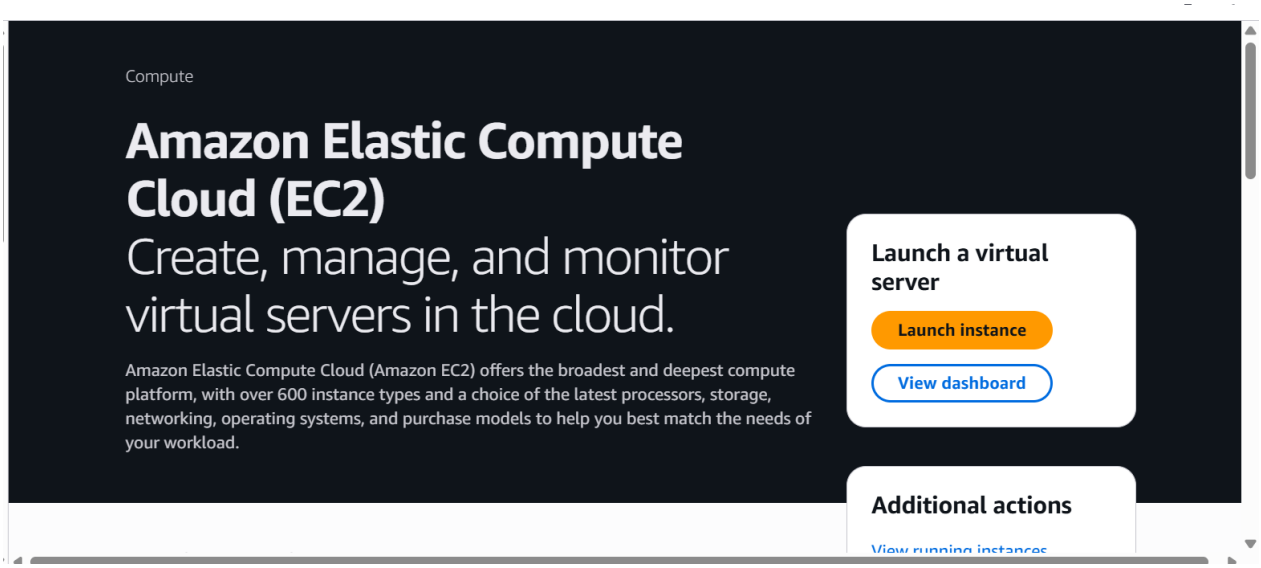
PRACTICAL – 2

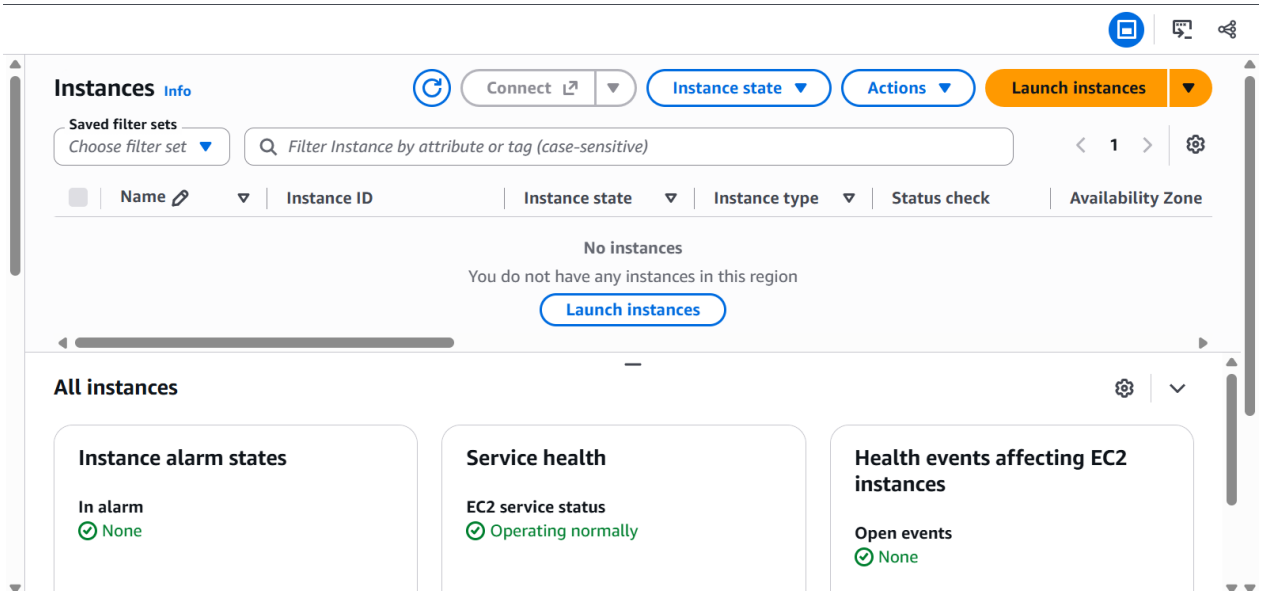
Launching and Connecting to EC2 Instances, and Using S3

Part 1: Linux Instance (mylinux)



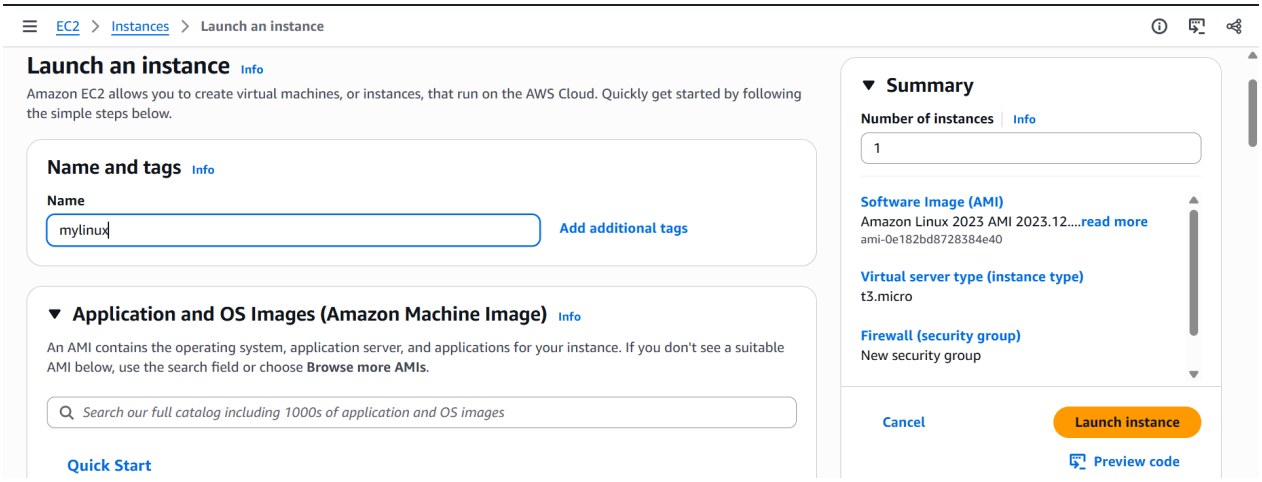
EC2 Service

Description: I searched for EC2 in the AWS Console and opened the Amazon Elastic Compute Cloud page. From here I clicked Launch instance to start creating a virtual server.



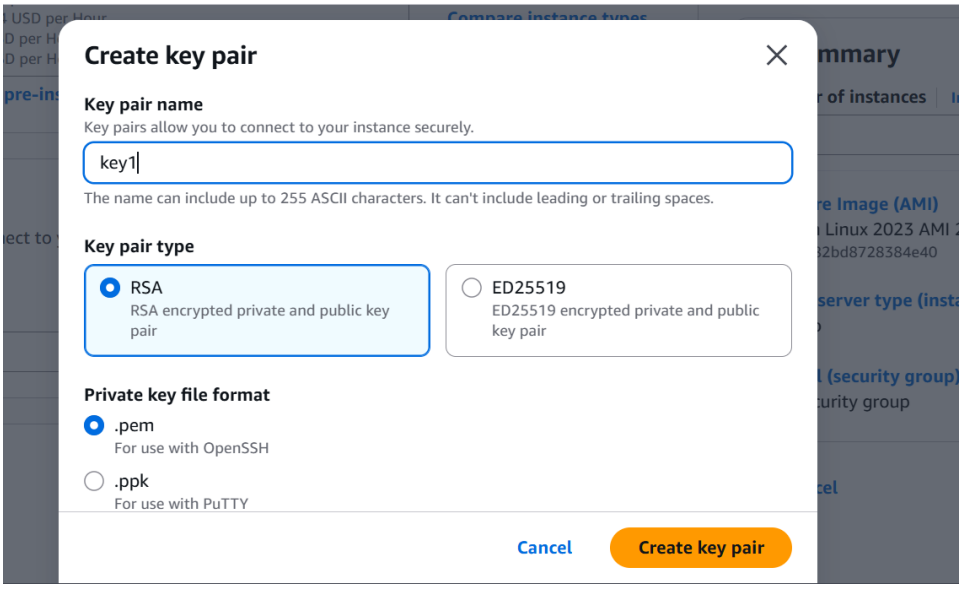
Instances Page

Description: The Instances page showed that there were no instances in the region yet. I clicked Launch instances.



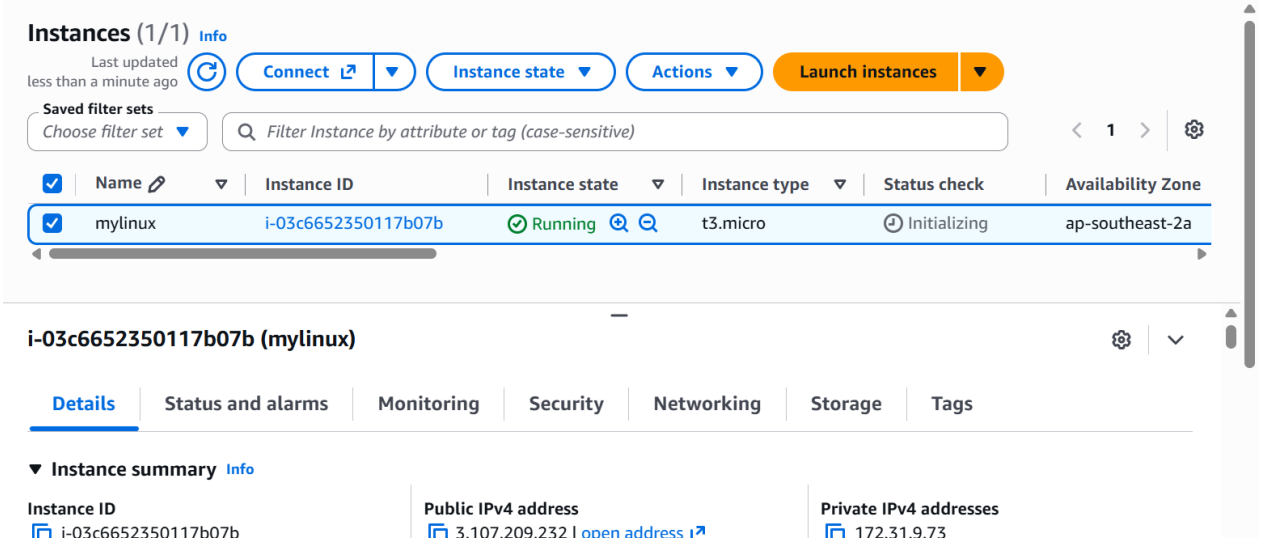
Name and Image

Description: I named the instance mylinux and selected Amazon Linux 2023 AMI as the operating system image. The instance type was t3.micro and the firewall was set to a new security group.



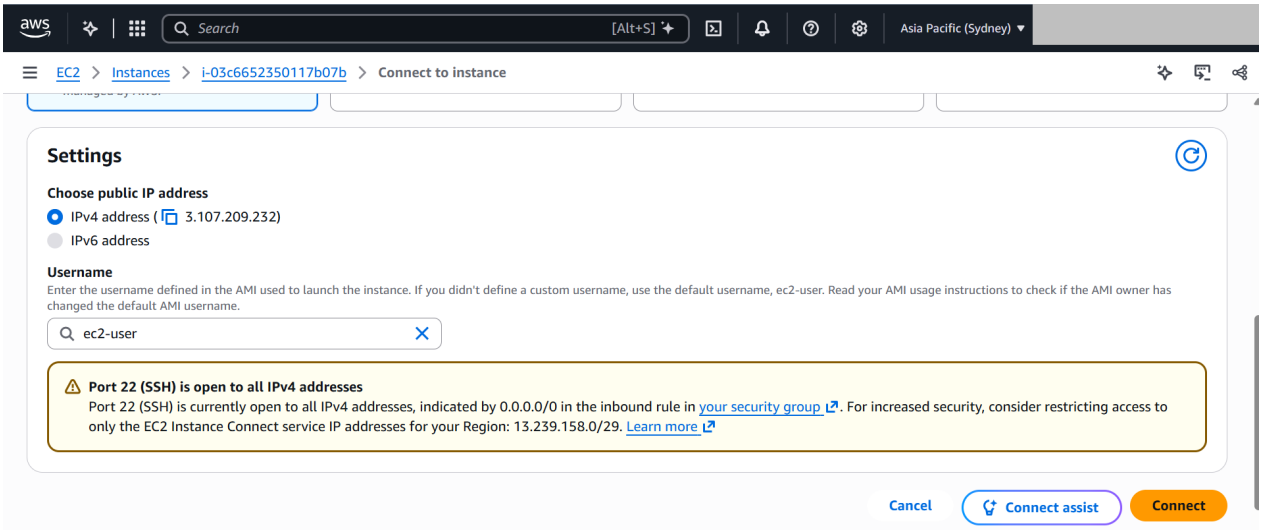
Create Key Pair

Description: I created a new key pair named key1 with type RSA and private key format .pem, then clicked Create key pair. The key file downloads to my computer and is used to connect securely.



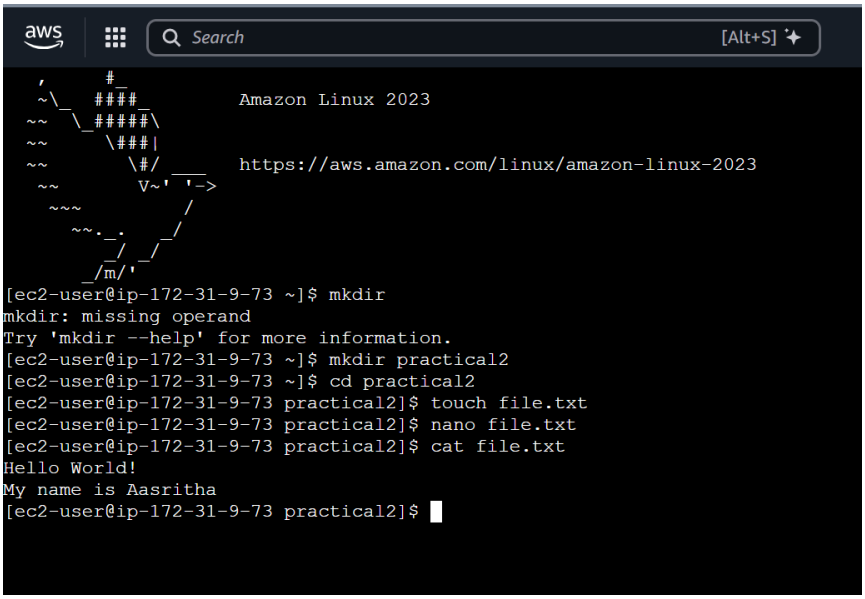
Instance Running

Description: After launching, the mylinux instance appeared in the list with the state Running. The instance type is t3.micro, and its Public IPv4 address is shown in the details.



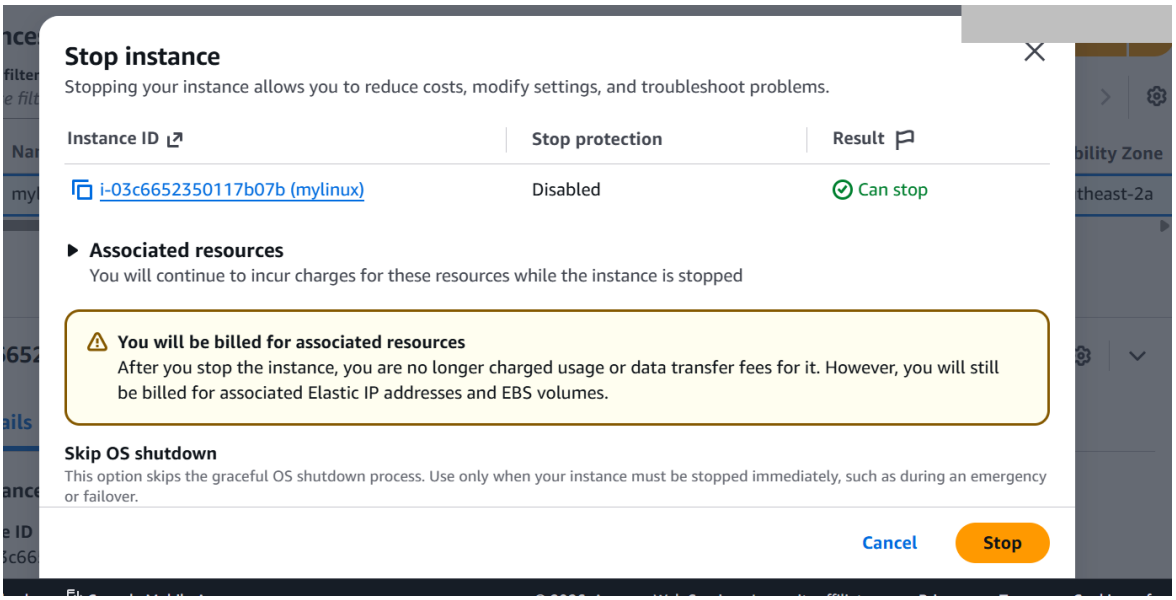
Connect to Instance

Description: I selected the instance and clicked Connect. On the Connect page I kept the public IPv4 address option, used the username ec2-user and clicked Connect.



Linux Commands

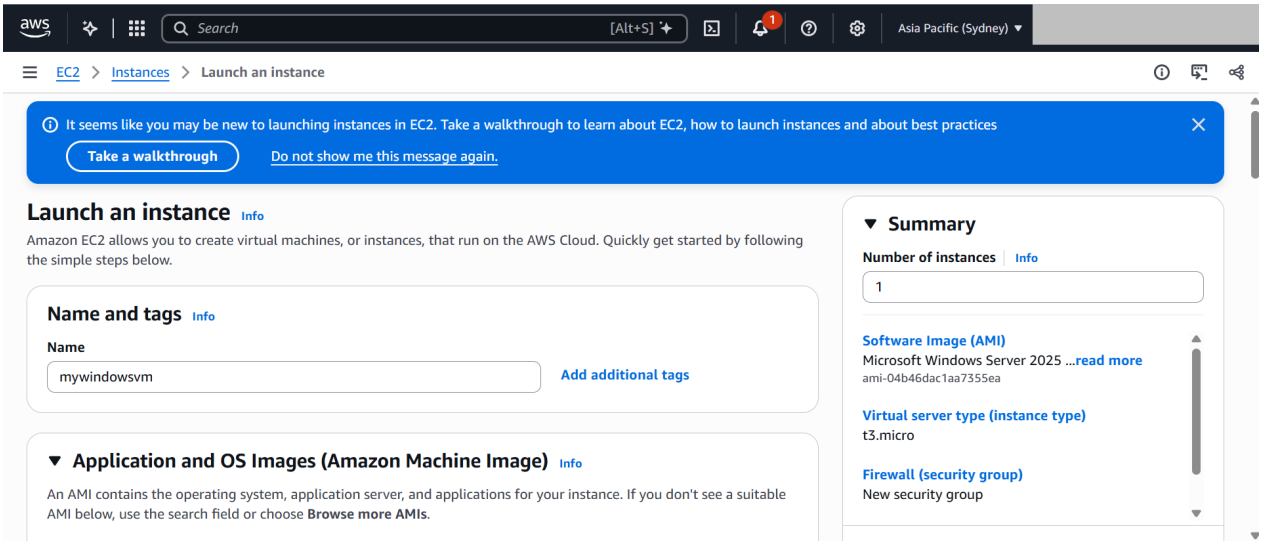
Description: A browser terminal opened. I first ran mkdir without a name, which gave an error. Then I created a folder with mkdir practical2, moved into it with cd practical2, created file.txt with touch, wrote text in it using nano, and displayed it with cat file.txt (Hello World! My name is Aasritha).



Stop Instance

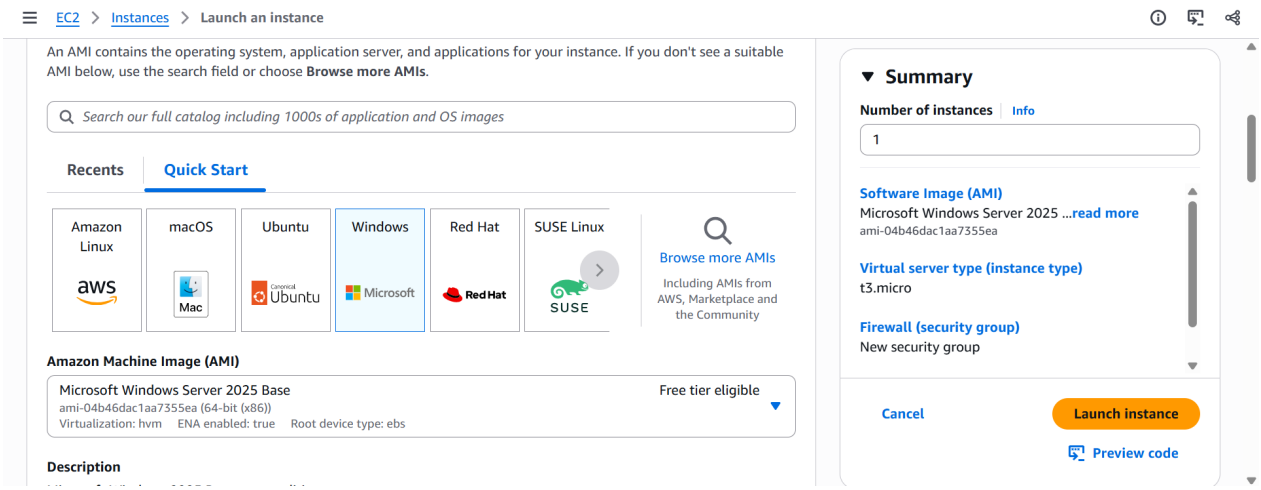
Description: After finishing, I selected the instance and chose Stop instance. In the confirmation box I clicked Stop so that the instance does not keep running and using up credits.

Part 2: Windows Instance (mywindowsvm)



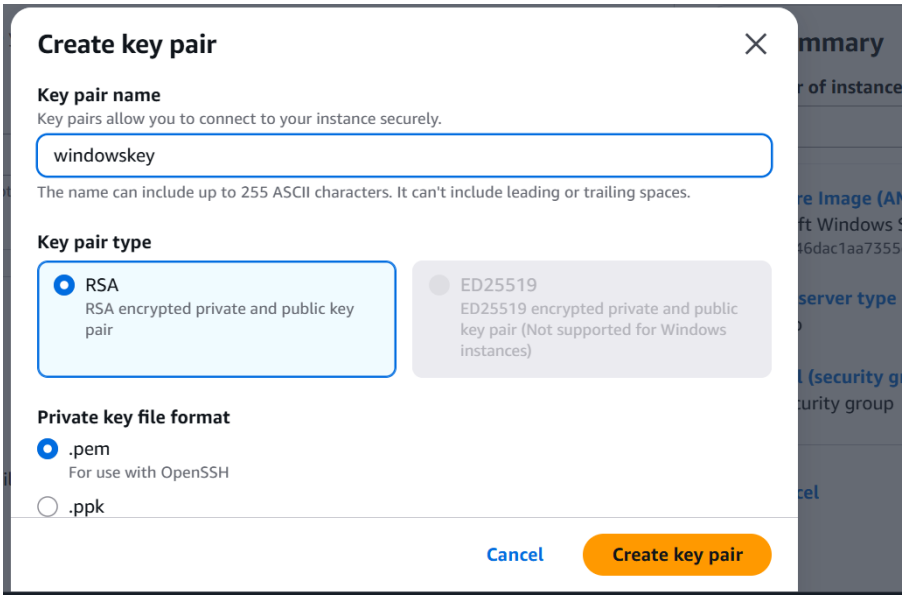
Launch Windows Instance

Description: I clicked Launch instance again and gave the name mywindowsvm.



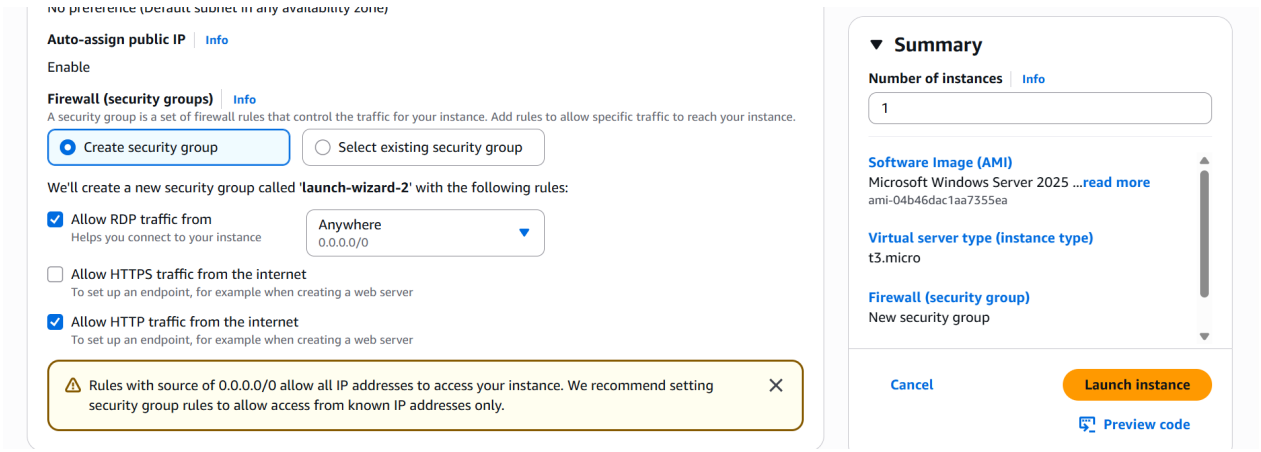
Choose Windows Image

Description: In the Quick Start list I selected Windows and chose Microsoft Windows Server 2025 Base, which is free tier eligible. The instance type was t3.micro.



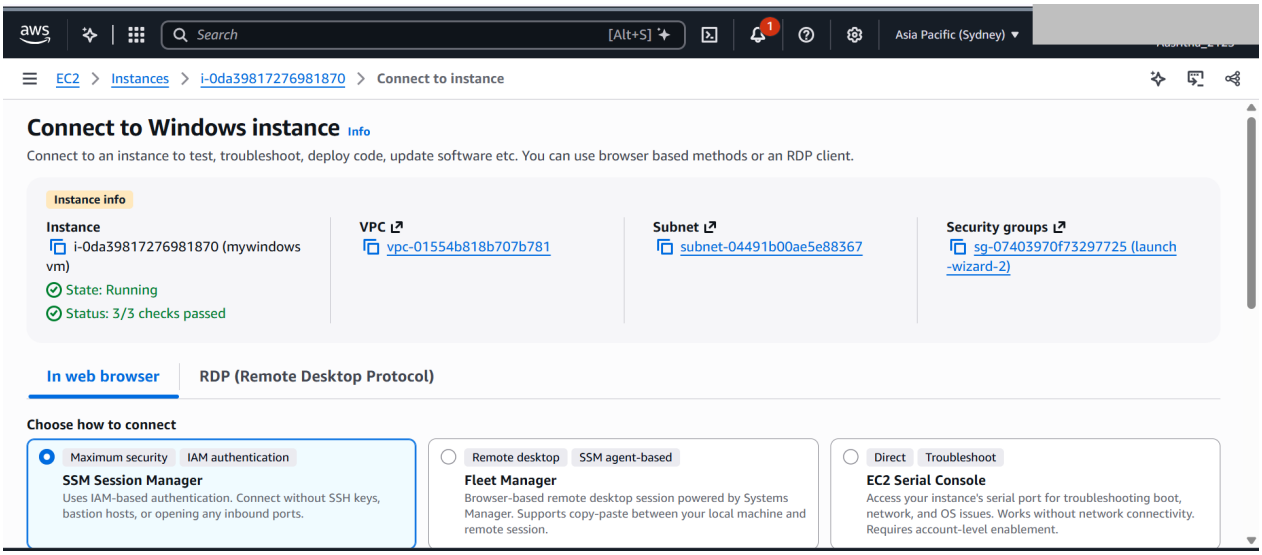
Create Key Pair

Description: I created a key pair named windowskey with type RSA and format .pem. ED25519 is greyed out because it is not supported for Windows instances.



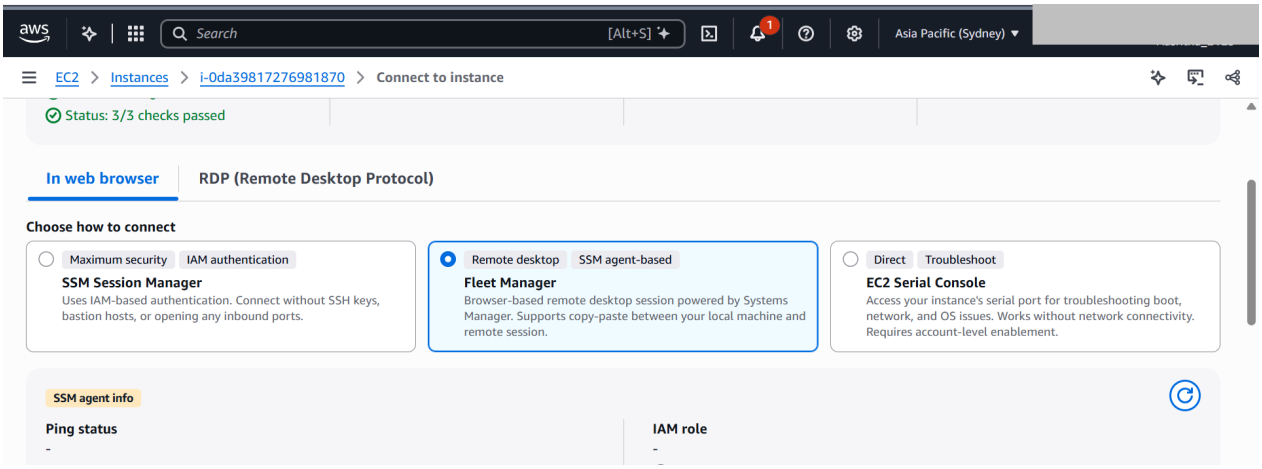
Network Settings

Description: I created a new security group and ticked Allow RDP traffic from Anywhere and Allow HTTP traffic from the internet. AWS shows a warning that rules open to 0.0.0.0/0 allow all IP addresses.



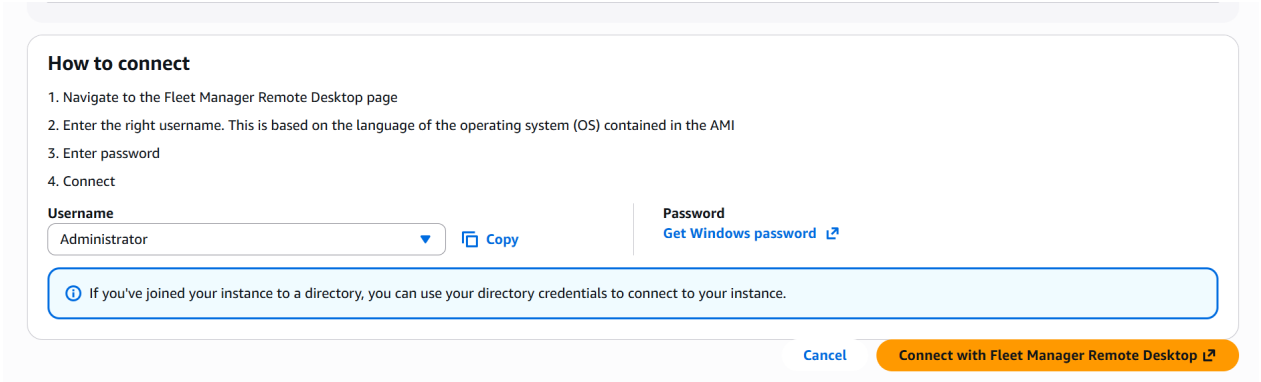
Connect to Windows Instance

Description: Once the instance was Running with 3/3 status checks passed, I opened the Connect to instance page. By default the SSM Session Manager option is selected under the In web browser tab.



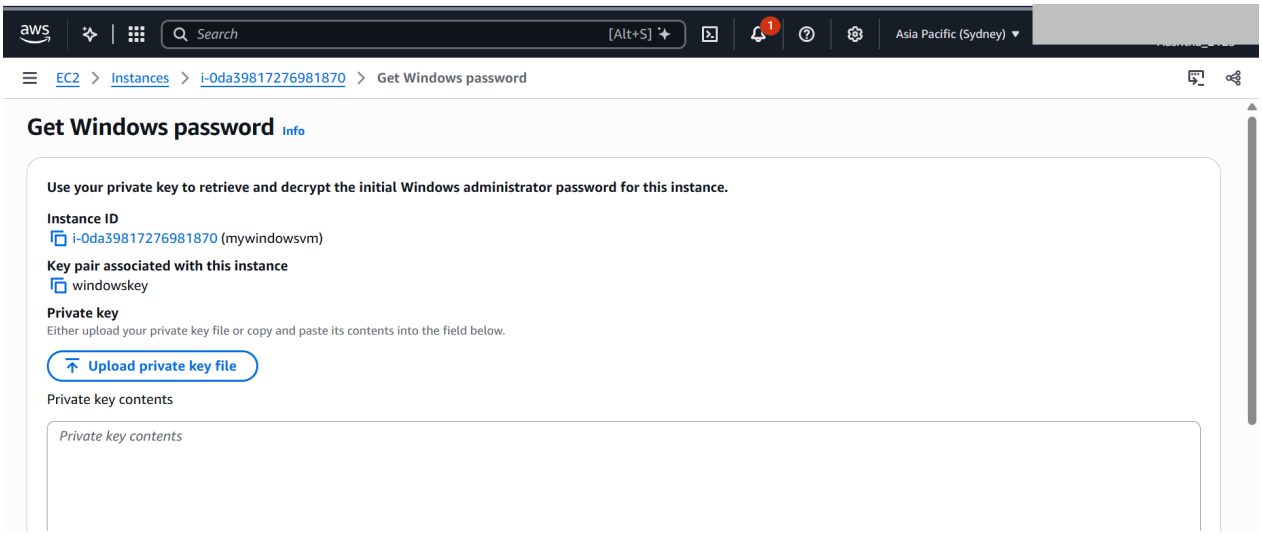
Choose Remote Desktop

Description: I changed the connection method to Remote desktop (Fleet Manager), which uses the SSM agent.



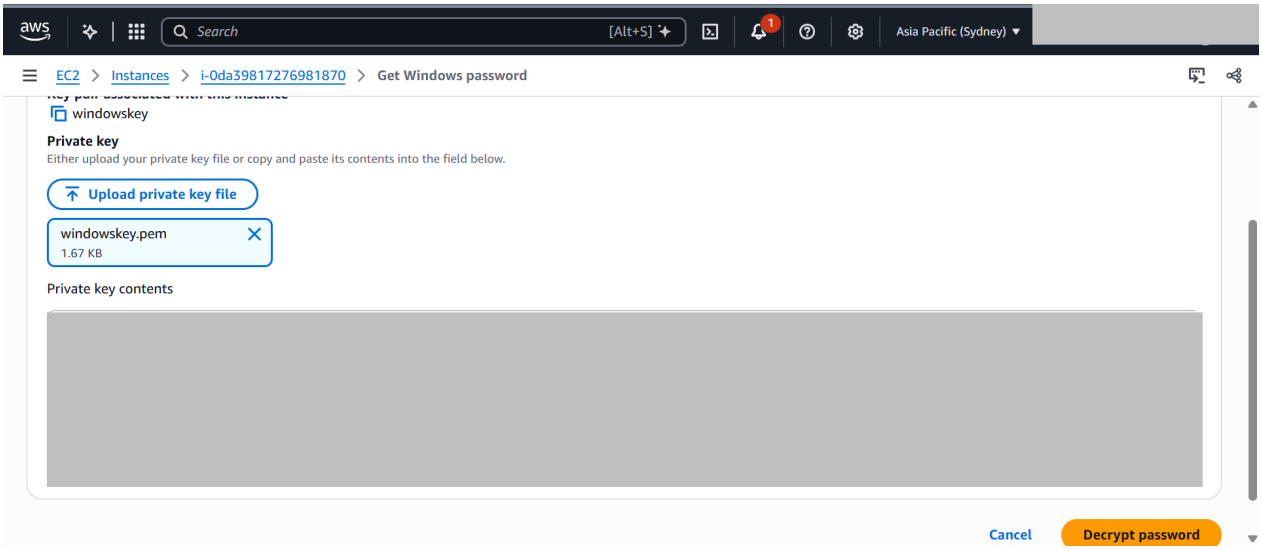
How to Connect

Description: The page shows the steps to connect. The username is Administrator, and I clicked the Get Windows password link to get the password.



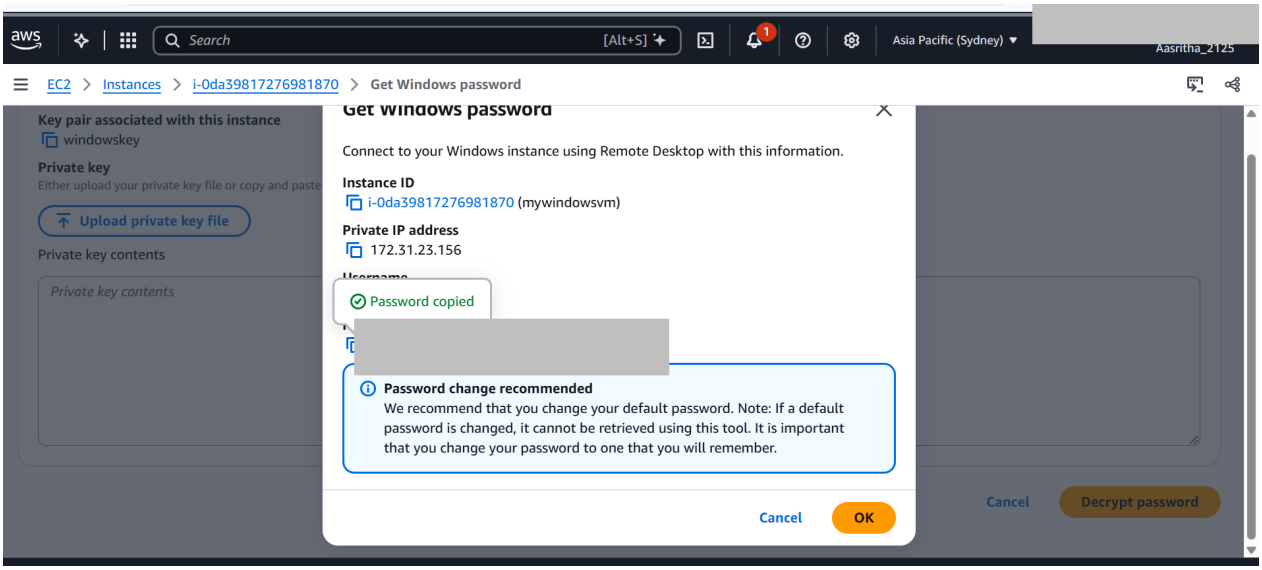
Get Windows Password

Description: On the Get Windows password page, the key pair associated with the instance is windowskey. I had to provide the private key to decrypt the password.



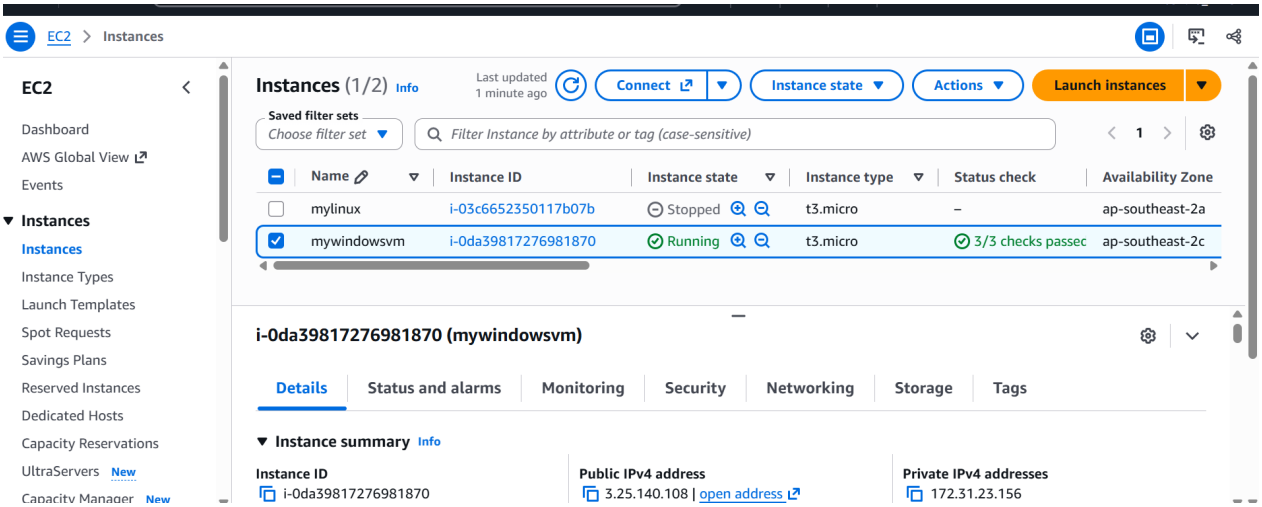
Upload Private Key

Description: I uploaded the windowskey.pem file, and its contents were filled in the Private key contents box. Then I clicked Decrypt password. (The key contents are hidden in this report.)



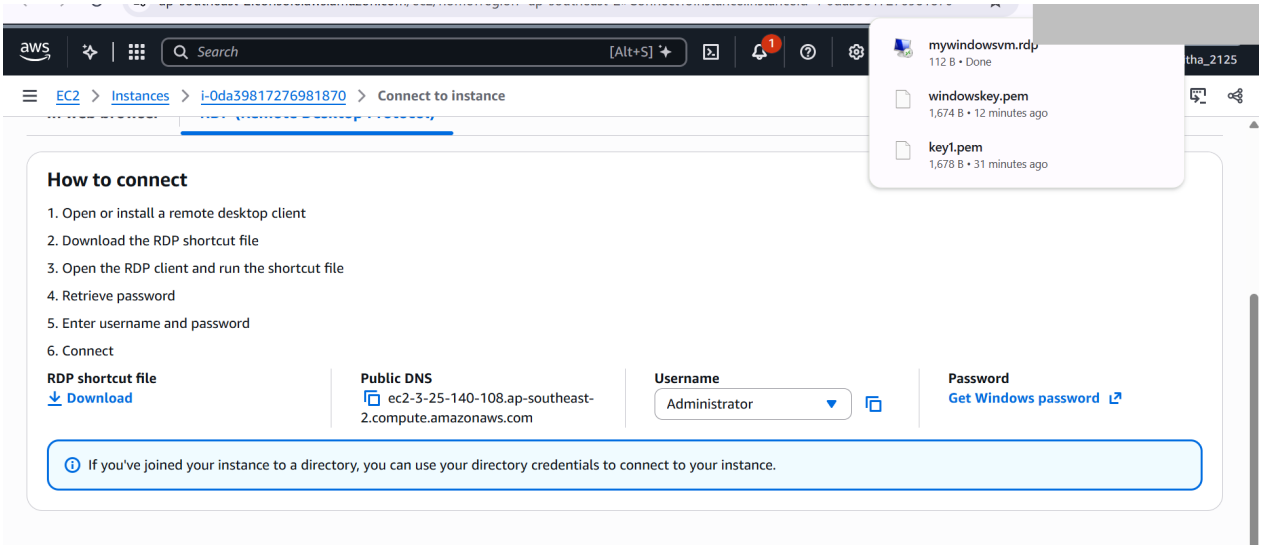
Password Decrypted

Description: AWS showed the decrypted Administrator password, and I copied it. AWS recommends changing the default password to one that I can remember. (The password is hidden in this report.)



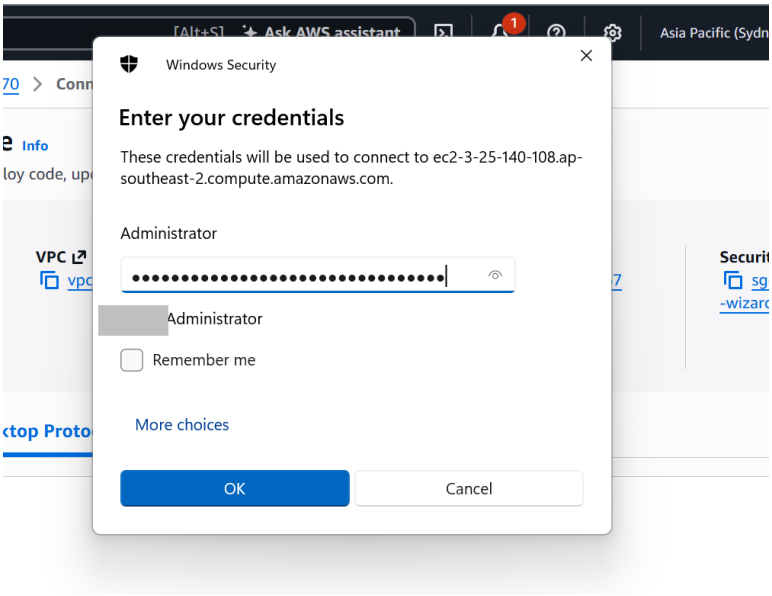
Instances List

Description: The Instances list shows mywindowsvm Running with 3/3 checks passed, and mylinux in Stopped state.



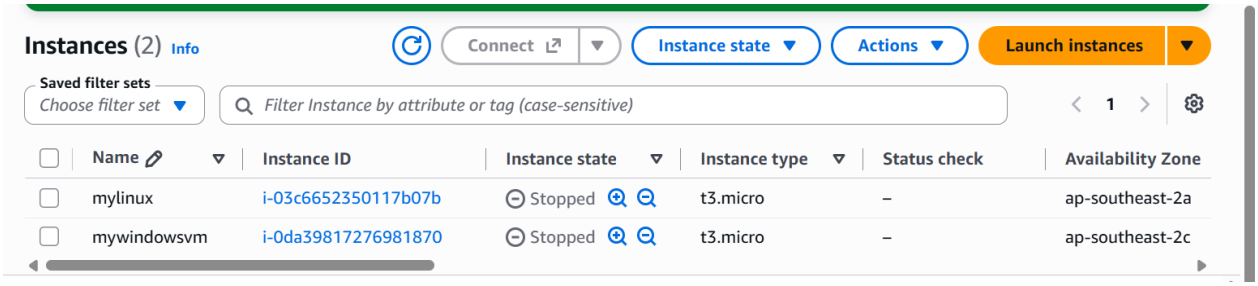
RDP Client

Description: In the RDP client tab I downloaded the RDP shortcut file (mywindowsvm.rdp). The page also shows the public DNS name, the username Administrator and the link to get the Windows password.



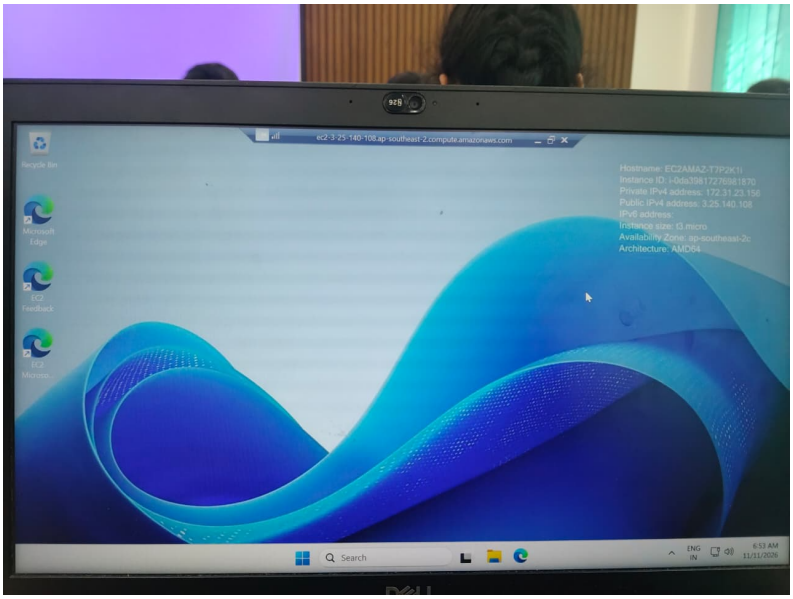
Enter Credentials

Description: I opened the downloaded RDP file, which asked for the credentials. I entered the Administrator password and clicked OK.



Instances Stopped

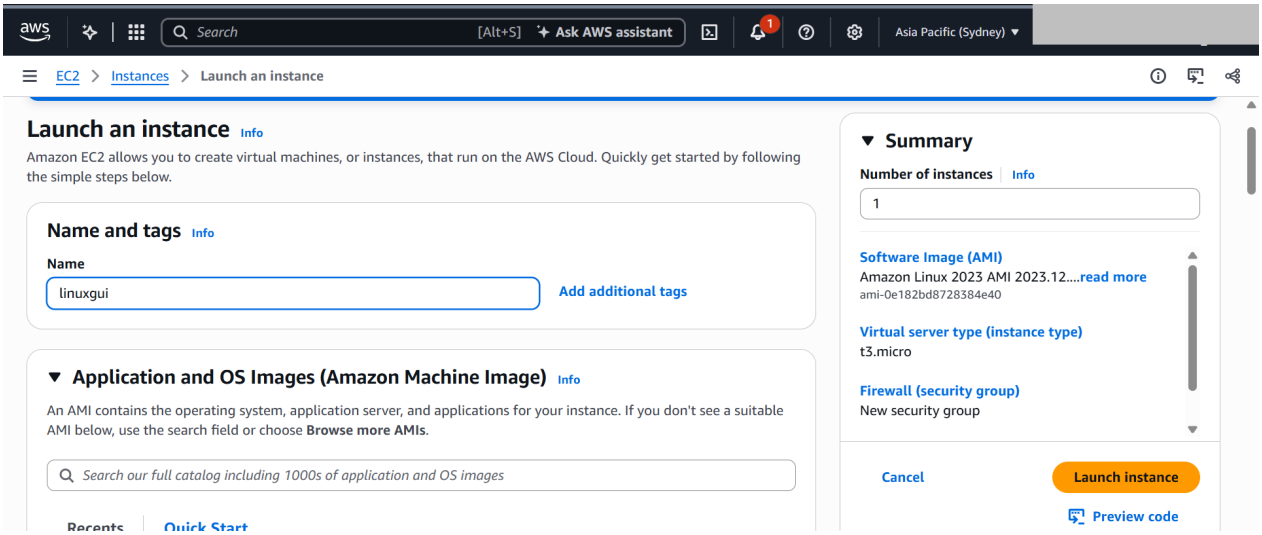
Description: Both instances, mylinux and mywindowsvm, are shown in the Stopped state.



Windows Desktop

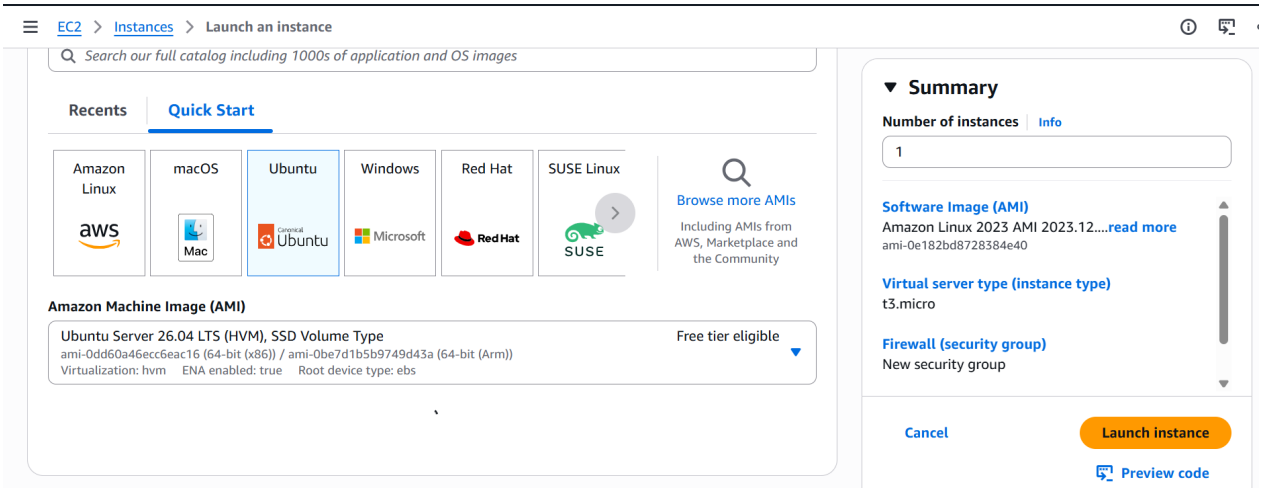
Description: The remote connection worked and the Windows Server desktop of the EC2 instance opened on my laptop.

Part 3: Linux GUI (linuxgui)



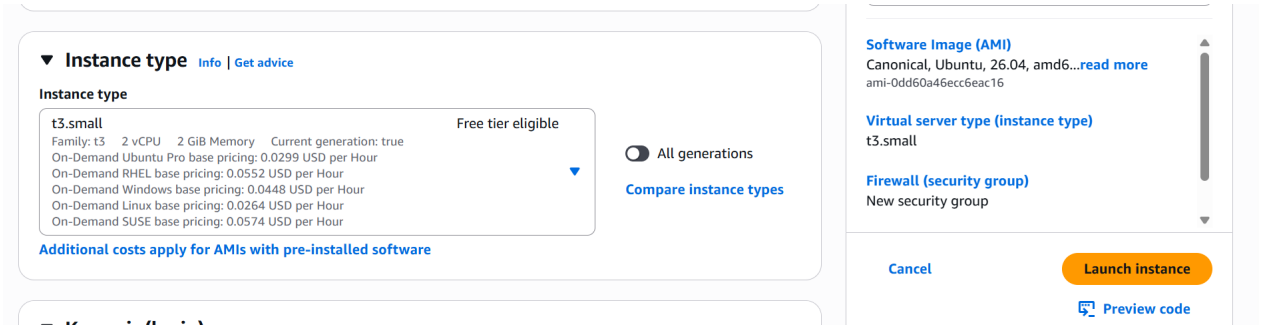
Launch Linux GUI Instance

Description: I clicked Launch instance again and named this instance linuxgui.



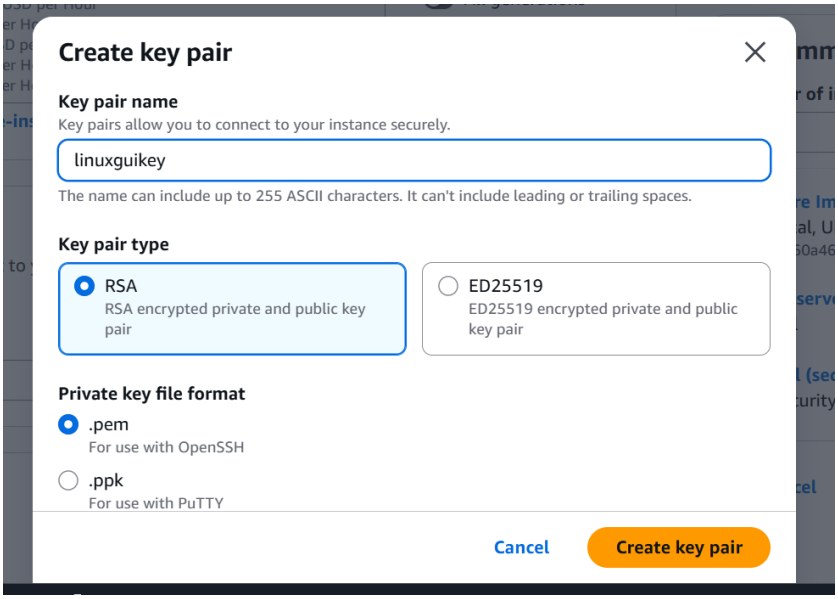
Choose Ubuntu Image

Description: In the Quick Start list I selected Ubuntu and chose Ubuntu Server 26.04 LTS, which is free tier eligible.



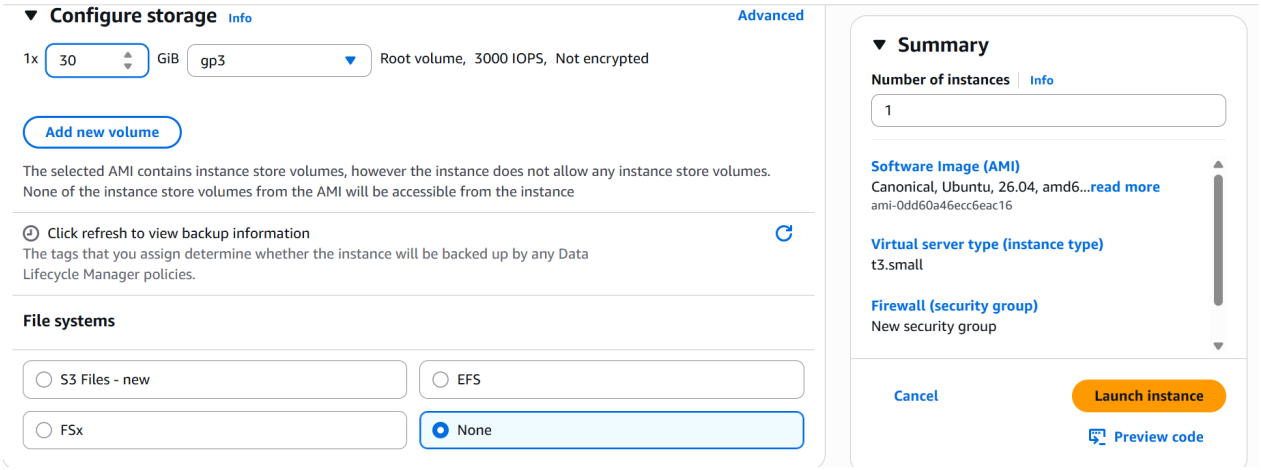
Instance Type

Description: I selected t3.small (2 vCPU, 2 GiB memory) as the instance type, since the desktop needs more memory.



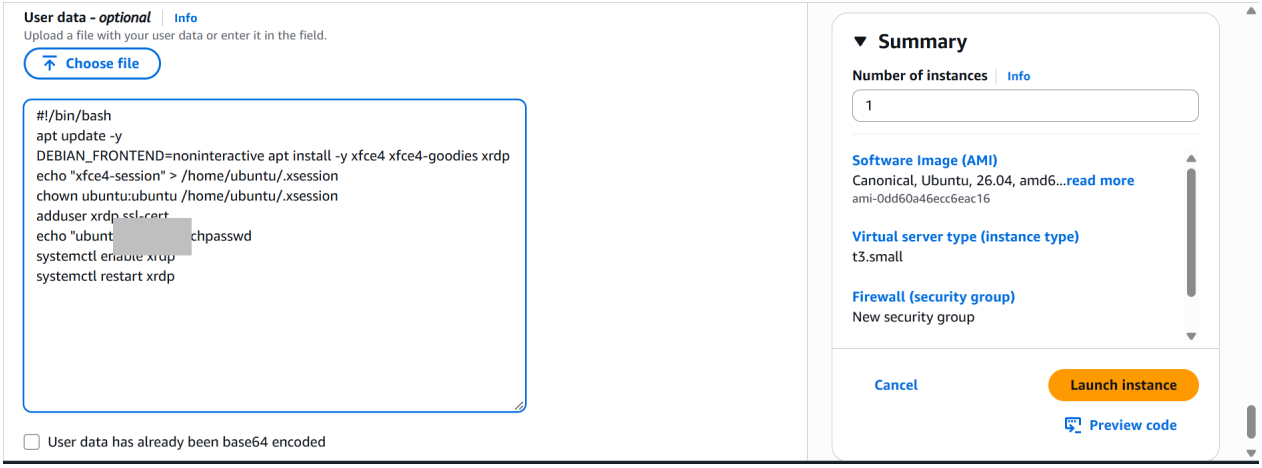
Create Key Pair

Description: I created a key pair named linuxguikey with type RSA and format .pem.



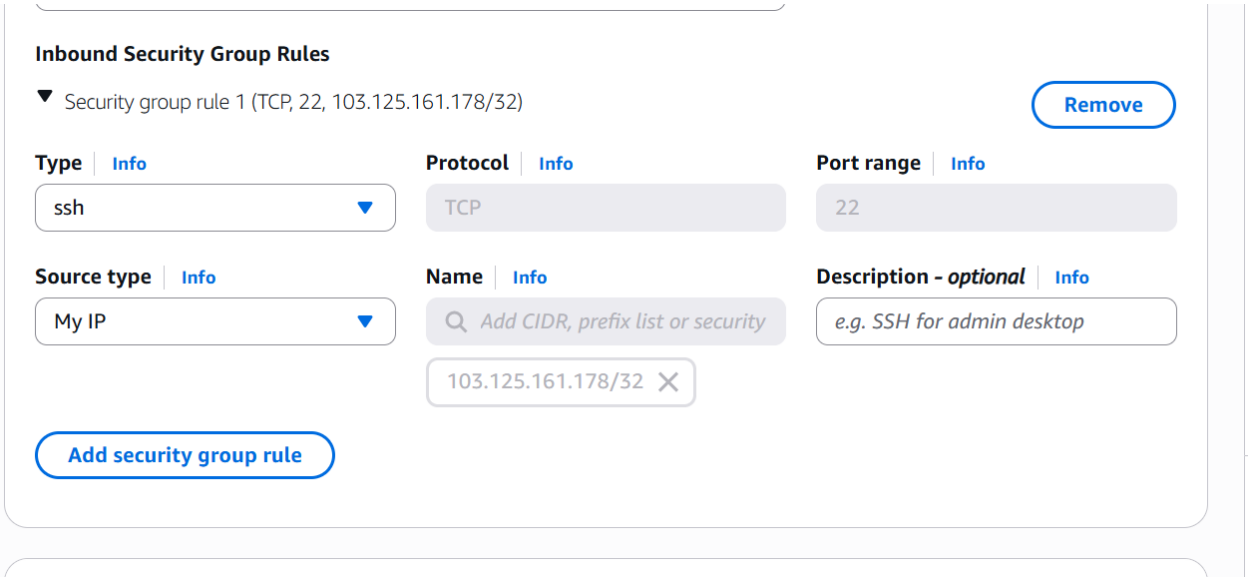
Configure Storage

Description: In Configure storage I set the root volume to 30 GiB (gp3) and left File systems as None.



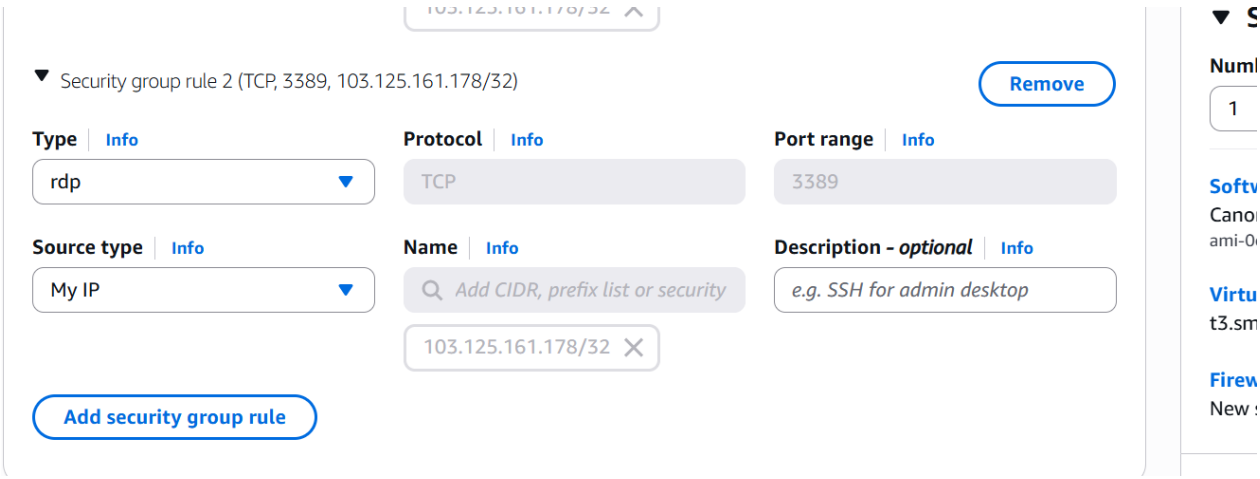
User Data Script

Description: In Advanced details, I pasted a script in the User data box. It updates the system, installs the XFCE desktop and xrdp, sets a password for the ubuntu user, and enables and restarts the xrdp service. (The password line is hidden in this report.)



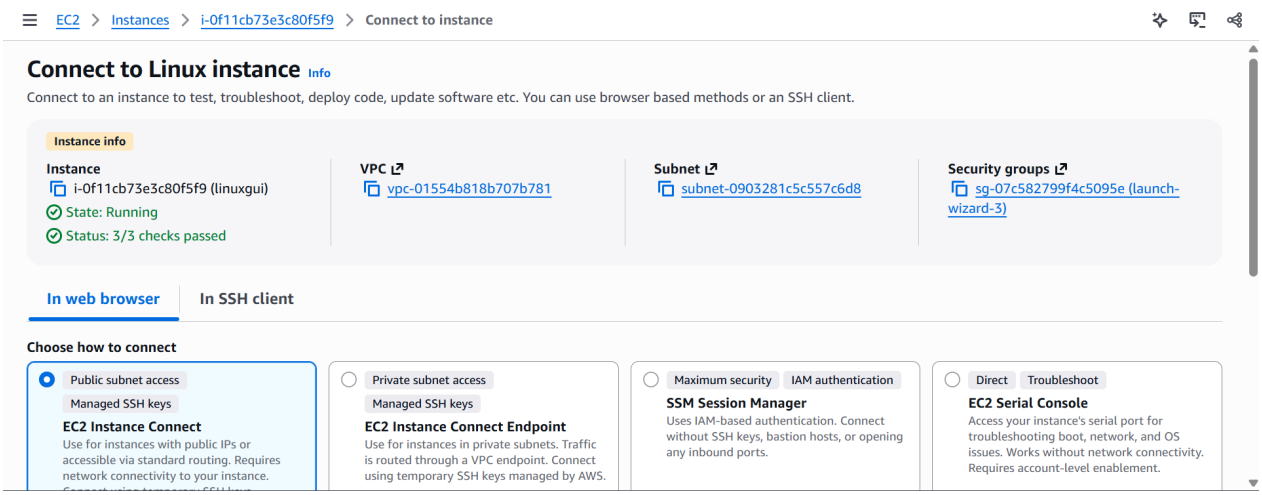
Security Group Rule 1

Description: In the inbound security group rules, rule 1 allows SSH (TCP, port 22) with the source type My IP.



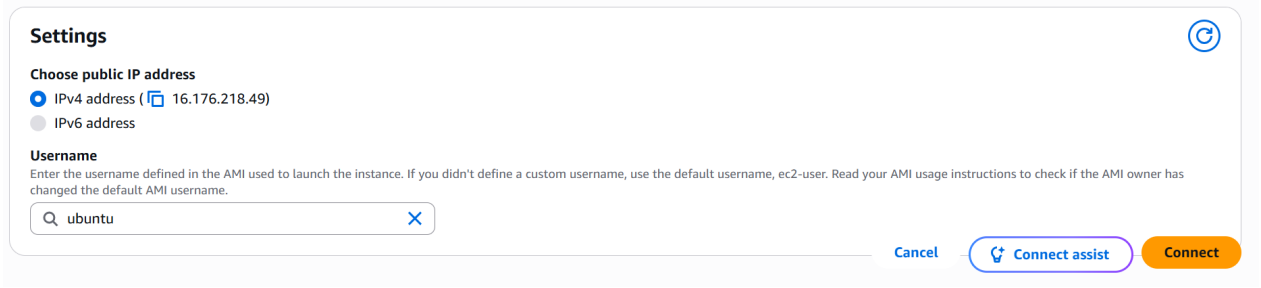
Security Group Rule 2

Description: I added rule 2 for RDP (TCP, port 3389), also with the source type My IP, so that I can connect with Remote Desktop.



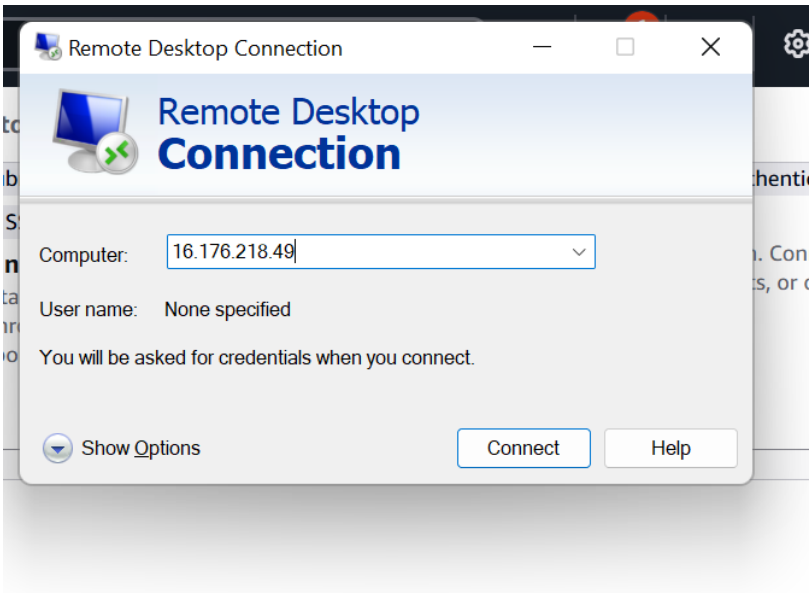
Connect to Linux Instance

Description: After launching, the linuxgui instance was Running with 3/3 checks passed. I opened the Connect page and noted the public IPv4 address, 16.176.218.49.



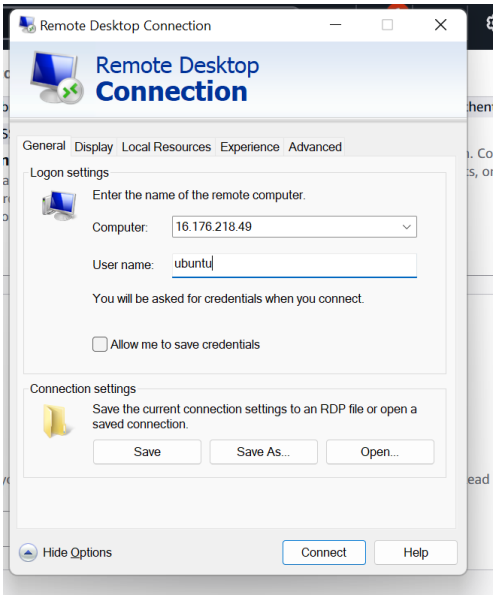
Connection Settings

Description: In the connection settings the public IPv4 address is shown and the username is ubuntu.



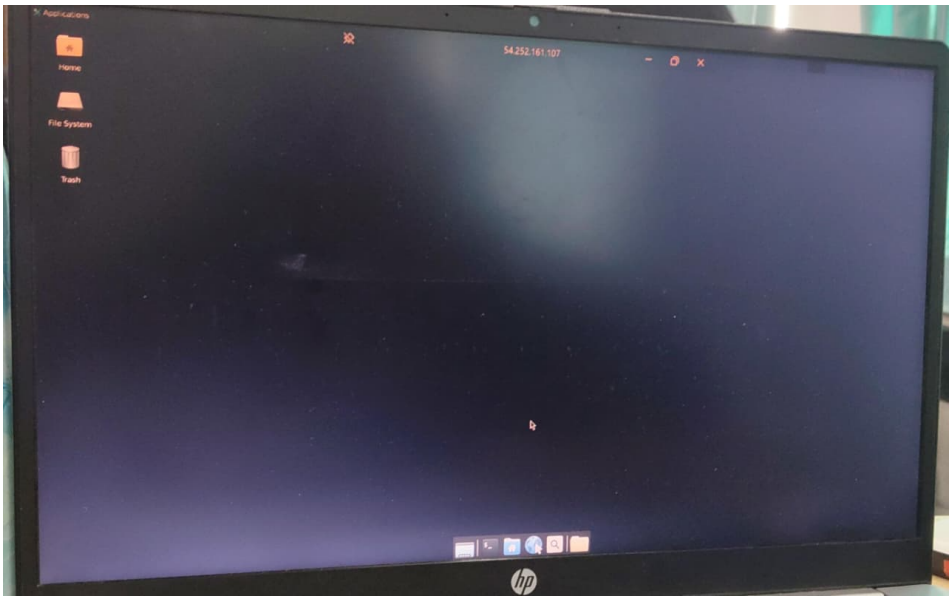
Remote Desktop Connection

Description: On my laptop I opened Remote Desktop Connection and typed the public IPv4 address in the Computer box.



Set Username

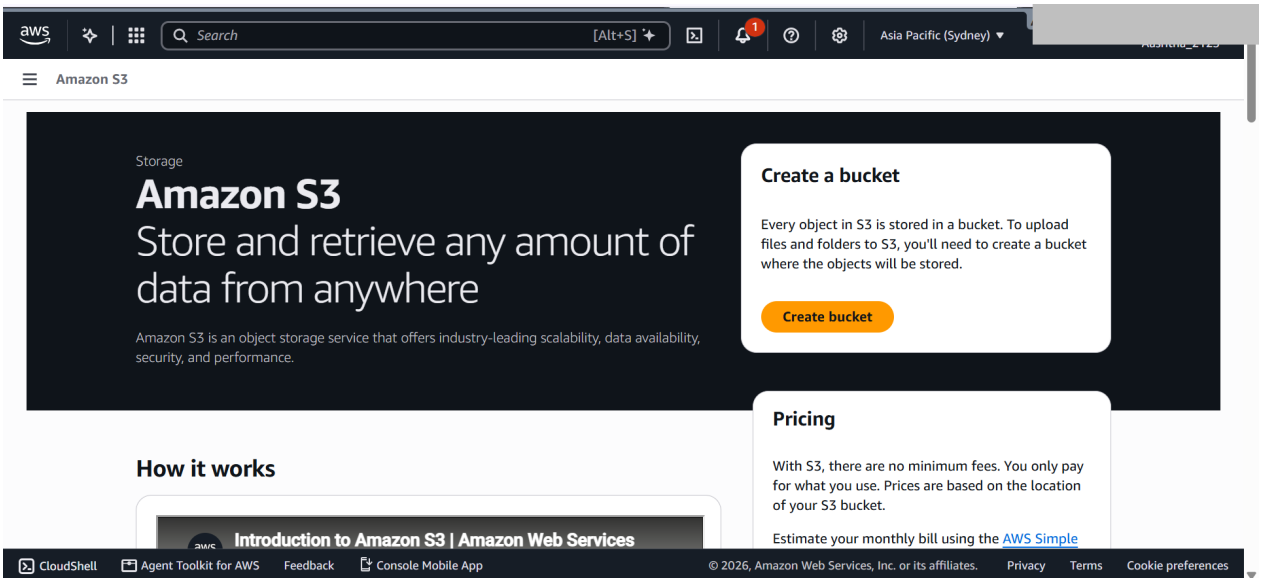
Description: I clicked Show Options and entered the user name ubuntu, then clicked Connect and gave the password when asked.



Linux Desktop

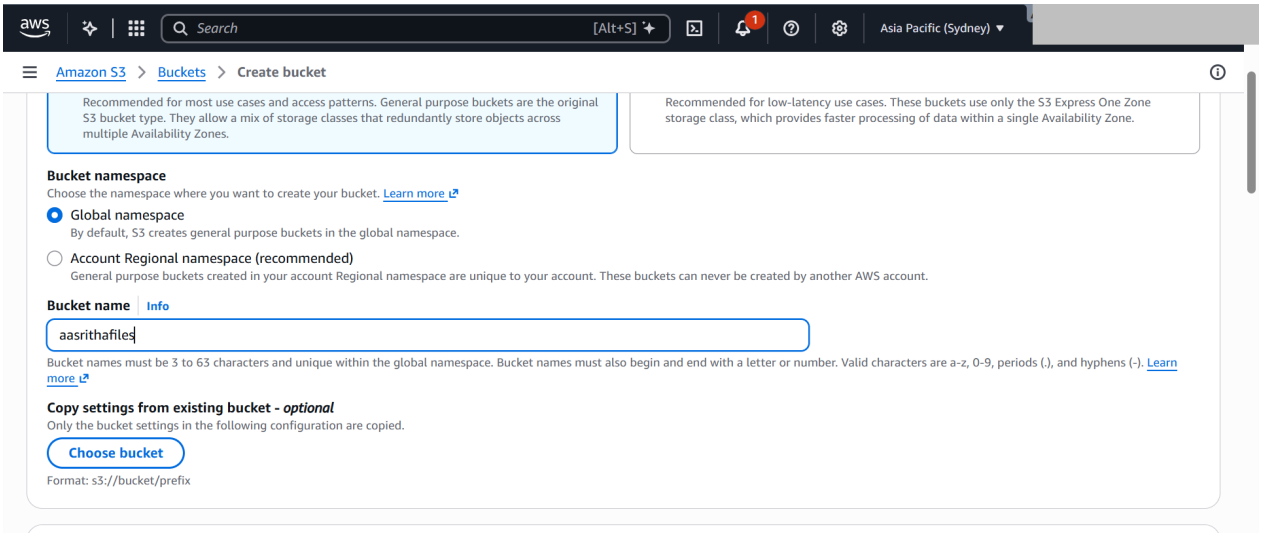
Description: The connection was successful and the Ubuntu XFCE desktop opened on my laptop.

Part 4: Amazon S3



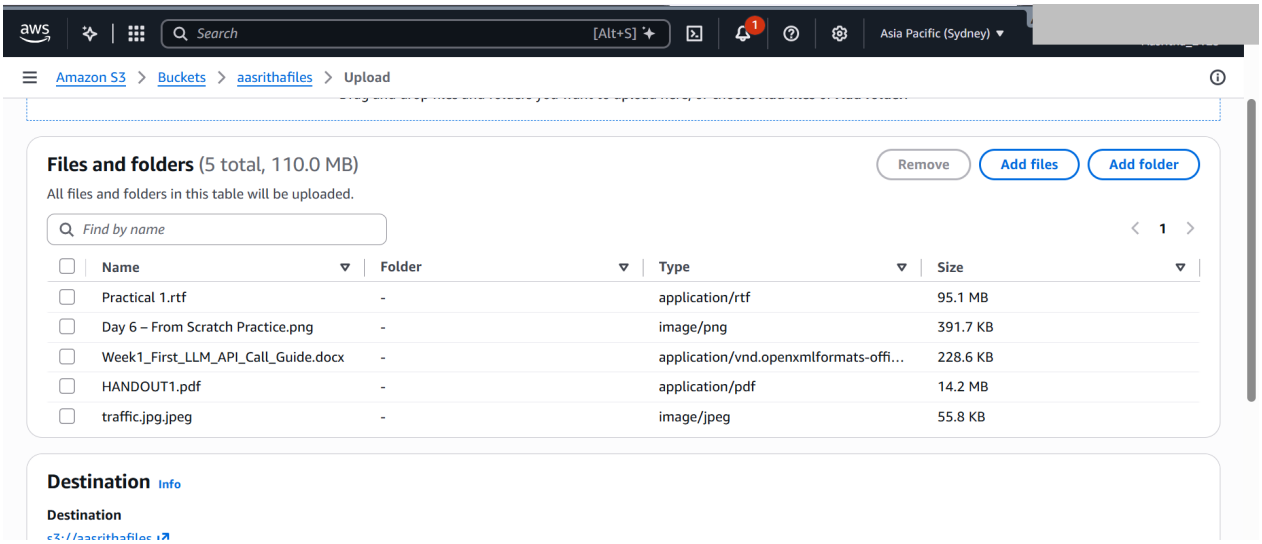
Amazon S3

Description: I opened the Amazon S3 service and clicked Create bucket.



Create Bucket

Description: I entered the bucket name aasrithafiles and kept the Global namespace option. Then I created the bucket.



Upload Files

Description: I opened the aasrithafiles bucket and clicked Upload. I added 5 files (110.0 MB in total) using Add files, and uploaded them to the bucket.